Shijie (Jay) Lin

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[portfolio URL]

Trained illustrator and business student who builds working software with AI coding agents. I work on the products people use to make things.

EDUCATION

Duke University, Fuqua School of Business · Master of Management Studies (MMS) — Expected May 2027

ArtCenter College of Design · BFA Illustration (Entertainment Design), Business Minor — May 2026

- GPA 3.6 · Honors · Merit Scholarship every term (2023–2026)

PRODUCT PROJECTS

Design-to-Code Readiness · Figma MCP benchmark and plugin (independent) — Oct 2026

- Pre-registered and ran a benchmark of 18 AI-agent builds through Figma MCP (6 screens × 3 levels of file structure); built the scoring harness for visual similarity, responsive breakage, code structure and theme propagation.
- Disproved my own layout hypothesis (every level scored SSIM ≥ 0.98), then found the factor that mattered: only files with bound variables produced code that followed a design-token change (100% vs. 25–67%). Turned it into a readiness-check plugin and a proposal for readiness notes in MCP responses.

Roco Kingdom: World · Hidden-progression teardown and redesign (independent) — Aug – Sep 2026

- Logged 6,632 throws across 10 play sessions and reverse-engineered 11 config tables to map a progression system players can't see; documented where the sample could and couldn't support conclusions.
- Wrote two redesigns, a low-cost progress-and-guarantee model and a higher-investment investigation loop, compared player control, repetition and build cost, and recommended the second with the first as fallback.

League of Legends · Live-ops proposals (independent) — Sep 2026

- Scoped three changes (battle-pass goal tracking, a match-fairness indicator that keeps individual MMR hidden, a two-day Worlds Clash) at ~54 person-weeks; break-even model shows goal tracking pays back at ~3,430 extra passes under stated assumptions.
- Set a priority order and the metrics each change must move after launch (returning-player reward claim rate, Clash sign-up rate).

EXPERIENCE

Riot Games · External Playtester, 2XKO Playtest Program — Jan – Apr 2025

- Ran structured playtests of tag, assist and fuse mechanics; isolated two new-player comprehension failures (special-move input tolerance, tag-timing payoff) and wrote onboarding and feedback recommendations shared with the design team.

Animal-sound rhythm game · Systems Designer, custom-controller game built for an alt.ctrl.GDC submission (7-person team) — Sep – Dec 2025

- Ran 4 playtest cycles of 20+ players each; sorted 20+ observations by failure type (controls, onboarding, feedback timing) and drove 4 iterations, re-testing each fix in the next cycle.
- Specified 10+ interface and feedback assets across character select, onboarding and hit feedback.

Snail Games USA · Concept Design Intern — May – Aug 2025

- Delivered 40+ environment and prop concept sets for an open-world game; annotated handoff sheets (material, function, structure) reduced revision rounds with the 3D team.

UNISON H.K. Holdings · Business Intern — Jun – Sep 2024

- Wrote 15+ Asia and US market-entry analyses and turned them into pitch decks that supported 5+ partner negotiations.

Lingruo Technology, Shanghai · Marketing Intern — Jan – Apr 2025

- Kept 200+ customer and product records and 100+ CRM entries current; coordinated day-to-day communication with 40+ B2B partners.

SKILLS

Product: user interviews and playtesting, metric design, sizing and break-even models, PRDs, SQL, Excel, Python

Build: Figma (auto layout, variables, components, MCP), Claude Code, Cursor, Codex, Next.js, Three.js, Unity, ComfyUI · built and deployed shijiedesign.com

Craft: Adobe Creative Cloud, Blender, Maya, Procreate · **Languages:** English, Mandarin (native)